# 7 You've Got Mail!

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## 1 Listen and Discuss

Read the four emails and decide what the purpose of each one is.

Your Shoe Source

Reply | Reply to all | Forward | Print | Delete

From: 'Saud Saleh' asaleh@finest_footwear.com
Subject: Response to your email
To: rogers@made_in_USA.com

Dear Mr. Rogers,

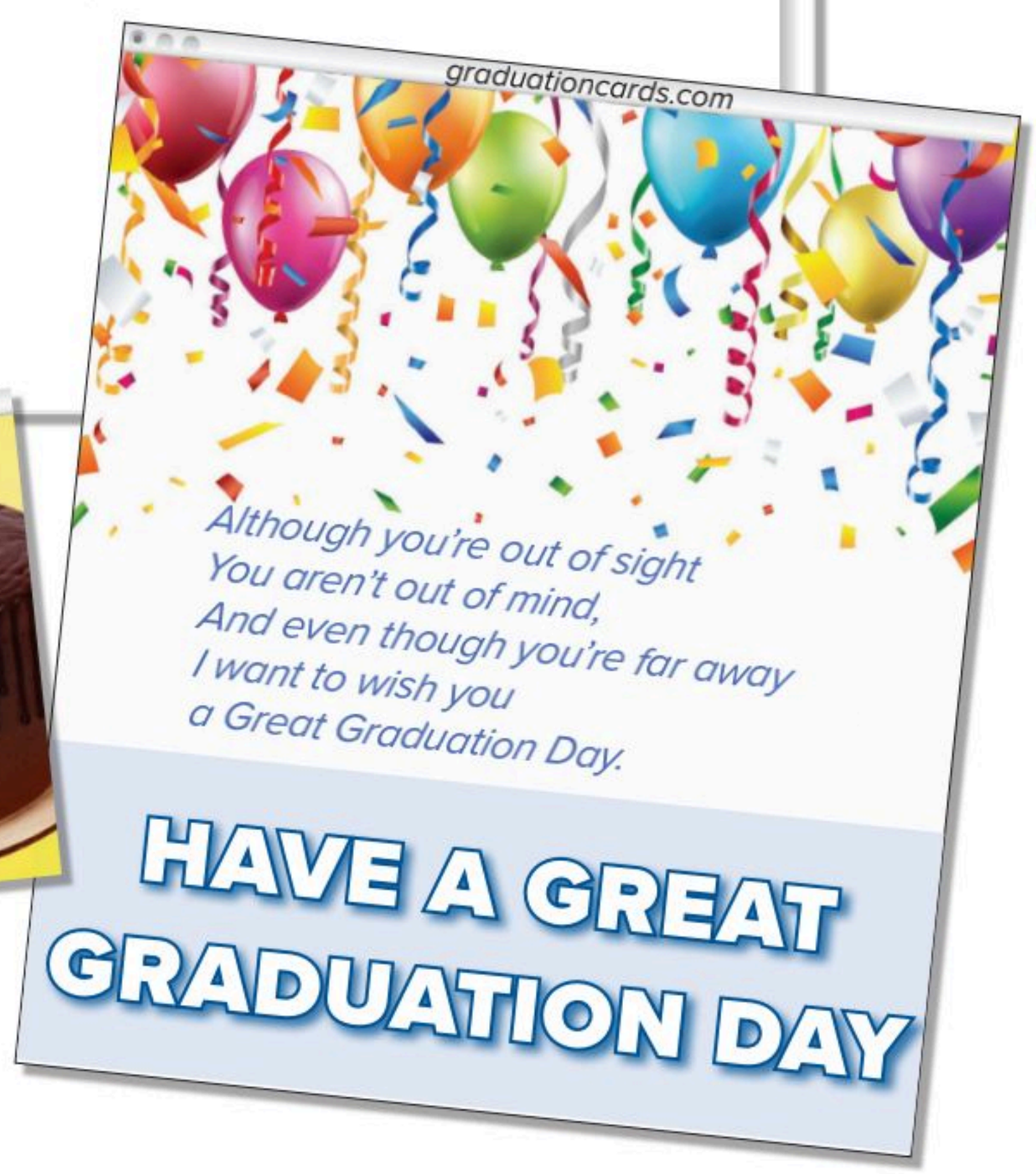
I want to apologize for not answering your email sooner. I've been traveling for the last few days, and I got back only yesterday.

Although most of our shoes are imported directly from Asia, we are currently looking for new suppliers, such as ones in the USA. I look forward to meeting you and discussing the various possibilities. Please email me as soon as you make your final travel arrangements to Saudi Arabia so that we can set up a time for a meeting.

Best regards,

Saud Saleh
Purchasing Manager

Finest Footwear International







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Mail

Reply | Reply to all | Forward | Print | Delete

From: David Hamilton <dhamilton@unicore.com>
Subject: Out of office reply for David Hamiliton
To: psmith@unicore.com

I will be out of the office from October 19 to 22 and will not have access to email.

For any urgent matters, please contact: shawn_taylor@unicore.com.

David Hamilton

Visit you in Paris

Reply | Reply to all | Forward | Print | Delete

To: olivia@megagoal.com
Cc:
Subject: Visit you in Paris

November 15

Hi Olivia,

How's work, and how's Paris? Hope you're getting used to your new way of life and taking advantage of living in such a wonderful city.

Guess what? I'm coming to France on vacation at the end of the month, and I'll be staying in Paris for a few days. I was wondering if you could put me up. However, I don't want to inconvenience you in any way. I'm used to sleeping anywhere. Let me know if it's all right if I stay with you.

What's the weather like now? Last time I was in Paris, it was so rainy that I was soaked most of the time, in spite of my raincoat and umbrella.

I'm really looking forward to seeing you again.

Your best friend,
Melanie

## Quick Check ☑

**A. Vocabulary.** Mark the ways to start or end letters or emails.

**B. Comprehension.** Answer ***true*** or ***false***.

1. _____ Mr. Saleh answered the email as soon as he returned.
2. _____ Mr. Saleh's company is not interested in doing business with Mr. Rogers.
3. _____ Although your friend is far away, they haven't forgotten your graduation day.
4. _____ David will answer all emails even though he's out of the office.
5. _____ Melanie is hoping to stay with Olivia even though it'll be inconvenient.
6. _____ Even though Melanie was wearing a raincoat, she got wet in Paris.

## 2 Pair Work

**A.** Apologize for something.

- I want to apologize for not coming to your graduation ceremony.
- Don't worry. That's quite all right.

**B.** Wish someone the best on a special occasion.

- Congratulations. I wish you lots of success.
- Thanks a lot. I'm looking forward to the new job.

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# 3 Grammar

## Preposition + Gerund

Prepositions can be followed by nouns, pronouns, or gerunds.

I apologized to **Allison**. *(noun)*
I apologized to **her**. *(pronoun)*
I apologized for **forgetting** her graduation day. *(gerund)*

Some verbs are usually followed by certain prepositions.

I **apologize for** arriving late.
I **look forward to** meeting you personally.
I**'m thinking of** moving to a new house soon.
I**'m dreaming of** going on vacation.
I **decided against** wearing a uniform.
I **insist on** paying for our lunch.
I **succeeded in** getting into college.
I **asked about** applying for a job.

Some adjectives are followed by certain prepositions.

I'm **tired of** waiting for an answer.
I'm **used to** having coffee at breakfast.

## *Although, Even Though, In Spite Of*

*Although, even though*, and *in spite of* have similar meanings.

*Although* and *even though* introduce a clause that has a subject and a verb.

*In spite of* is followed by a noun or gerund.

**Although** it rained, we enjoyed the vacation.
**Even though** I was tired, I couldn't sleep.
**In spite of** the traffic, I arrived on time.
He went to school **in spite of** being sick.

## *As Soon As, When*

These conjunctions of time are not followed by future forms of verbs even though the verbs tell us about future time. The present is used instead.

I'll tell you **as soon as** I <u>know</u>.
I'll call you **when** I <u>arrive</u>.

## *So ... (That)*

Use **so** with an adjective or with *many, much, few,* or *little* to express result or degree.

The noise was **so loud** (that) we could hardly hear ourselves talk.
There were **so many** cars (that) we couldn't find a place to park.

Read each example in the grammar section. Find sentences in the emails that are similar and underline them.

**A.** Complete the sentences with ***although*** or ***in spite of***.

1. _____ her busy schedule, Maya always remembers her friends' events.
2. _____ Steve had all the right qualifications, he wasn't chosen for the job.
3. Our team lost the game _____ we played much better than the other team.
4. We had a really good time at the beach _____ the cloudy weather.
5. _____ she has a Russian last name, she was actually born in Canada.

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**B.** Use the following words to complete the paragraph:
***although, as soon as, because, but, during, in spite of***

# The Telegraph System

In 1830, an American, Joseph Henry (1797-1878), demonstrated the potential of William Sturgeon's invention, the electromagnet, for long distance communication. (**1**) _____ it was Samuel Morse who was able to invent a telegraph system that was practical and commercially feasible.

(**2**) _____ 1835 Morse was a professor of arts and design at New York University, when he proved that signals could be transmitted by wire. The system was received rather indifferently in 1838, (**3**) _____ an impressive public demonstration.

(**4**) _____ Morse and his associates were eager to set up an experimental line, funding was not approved until a few years later. So, (**5**) _____ Congress approved a funding of $30,000, the construction of a line started between Washington and Baltimore.

Samuel Morse and his associates managed to raise private funds and extended their line to Philadelphia and New York. Telegraph companies started functioning in different parts of the United States. (**6**) _____ of this, Western Union soon joined, dispatching telegraphs by train. Eventually, telegraph systems were set up all over the world. It was the beginning of a new era in communication.

**C.** Match the two parts of the sentences about an outing.

| | |
|---|---|
| **1.** ___ There was so much traffic on the road | **a.** we weren't able to swim. |
| **2.** ___ The picnic spot was so crowded | **b.** it took hours to get to the beach. |
| **3.** ___ The water was so cold | **c.** we went straight to bed. |
| **4.** ___ There were so many mosquitoes | **d.** I got a headache. |
| **5.** ___ The beach was so noisy | **e.** we weren't able to find a good place to sit. |
| **6.** ___ We were all so tired in the evening | **f.** the children were bitten all over. |

**D.** Complete the sentences about yourself. Then compare with a partner.

I'm thinking of *studying in a foreign country*.

1. I'm interested in _____.
2. I'm excited about _____.
3. I'm thinking of _____.
4. I'm looking forward to _____.
5. I'm not used to _____.
6. I'm tired of _____.
7. I apologized to my friend for _____.
8. I'm not capable of _____.
9. I'm used to _____.
10. I decided against _____.

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## 4 Language in Context

Make a list of things you're ***used to doing*** and ***not used to doing*** and compare with a partner.

## 5 Listening

Listen to the messages or conversations. Complete the sentences.

1. **a.** Mr. Kramer's assistant is apologizing for _____.
   **b.** Mr. Kramer wants to _____.
2. **a.** Nawal is thinking of _____.
   **b.** Sabah is looking forward to _____.
3. **a.** Omar is apologizing for not _____.
   **b.** At the end, Omar is thinking of _____.
4. **a.** Raymond is making excuses for not _____.
   **b.** He wants to _____.

## 6 Pronunciation

**A.** Listen to the following vowel sounds. They are sometimes called short vowels. Then practice.

| /e/ | /æ/ | /ɪ/ |
|---|---|---|
| **se**nd | h**a**ppy | w**i**sh |
| g**e**t | sp**a**m | c**i**ty |
| l**e**tters | congr**a**tulations | **i**nterested |

**B.** Read the emails again and underline only the words that have short ***e***, ***a***, and ***i***. Practice reading the sentences aloud without stressing the short ***e***, ***a***, and ***i*** in the words you underlined.

## 7 About You

In pairs, ask the questions and have your friend answer. Then switch roles.

1. Are people in your country used to sending email, letters, or cards on special occasions?
2. When did you last apologize for doing something wrong? What did you do?
3. Are you the kind of person who forgives easily? Explain.
4. When you are/were absent from school, do/did your parents write notes to your teachers explaining your absence?
5. Are you used to doing favors or asking other people for favors? Explain.
6. Do you put people up when they travel? Do you ask others to put you up when you travel?

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# 8 Conversation

Underline the words that have short ***e***, ***a***, and ***i***. In pairs, read the conversation aloud without stressing the short ***e***, ***a***, and ***i*** in the words you underlined.

**Ahmed:** Abdullah, thanks for inviting me to your graduation event. I was really looking forward to next Thursday night, ...

**Abdullah:** I've been planning this event for ages! You're coming, aren't you?

**Ahmed:** Well, Abdullah, I'm calling you up to explain. Unfortunately I'm not going to be able to make it.

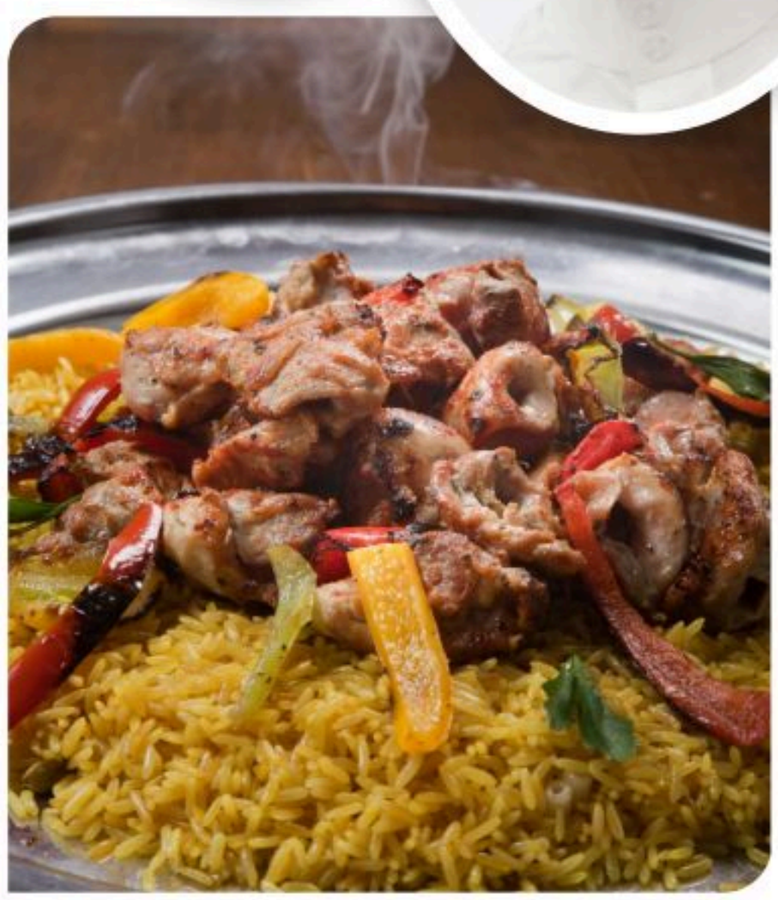
**Abdullah:** No way! I refuse to accept that. I insist on your coming.

**Ahmed:** I'm sorry, I really am. You see, it's my uncle's wedding, and they're having the whole family over for dinner. They expect me to be there, and I can't let them down.

**Abdullah:** So, sneak out as soon as the dinner's over.

**Ahmed:** I can't just walk out like that.

**Abdullah:** Of course you can.



## Your Ending

What does Abdullah go on to suggest?

1. No one's going to notice.
2. Tell your uncle you're not feeling well, and you're going to lie down.
3. Be straight with your uncle, and tell him you have plans after dinner.
4. Your idea: _____

### Real Talk

*No way! = used to say you won't allow something*
*let someone down = disappoint*
*Of course = used to give someone permission or encouragement*
*Be straight = be honest and frank*

## About the Conversation

In pairs, ask and answer the questions. Then switch roles.

1. What was Ahmed looking forward to?
2. Why can't he come to the graduation?
3. What does Abdullah want Ahmed to do?

## Your Turn

Role-play these situations with a partner.

1. You can't come to a friend's graduation ceremony. Make up a reason and apologize for not coming.
2. Call a friend and accept an invitation to a dinner, an event, or an outing.

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## 9 Reading

### Before Reading

Read the passage and find all the sentences that talk about the different means of communication. Compare what you found with a partner.

# From Smoke Signals to Email: *Keeping in Touch*

*From the Stone Age to the present, people have shown a desire to send messages to one another over long distances.*

In ancient times, according to one story, a chain of fires on mountaintops was used to relate the news of the fall of Troy to people in Greece. In the past, native people in the Americas used smoke from fires to transmit messages. They developed a code—in which certain combinations of smoke rising had special meanings. For example, two parallel columns of smoke indicated the successful return of a war party.

The ancient Greeks established lines of signal towers at mountain-tops. At each one, a large fire was lit to transmit a signal to the next tower, and in this way, information was passed on through the land. Also, almost anything that makes a noise has been used for signaling. A kind of drum talk is still used in Central Africa today, although few who are not natives have been able to understand it. The sender uses a drum that can produce a high or low tone. Because the local dialect alternates in these tones, the sender is able to simulate speech with the drums.

In modern times, people have communicated by letter, telegraph, and telephone. But no one method has become as widespread as quickly as the use of email. The first email message took place in 1971, and according to its sender, Ray Tomlinson, it was probably the following: "QWERTYUIOP." What was significant about that? Nothing, really. This is just the top row of keys on an English-language keyboard. Tomlinson was just testing out the system and using a nonsense message. He had no concept that he was going to start a revolution in communication.

Tomlinson was one of a group of scientists who were working on developing better computers. The scientists at his site were able to send a message to a "mailbox" on the computer on their site. Other scientists could view the messages in the mailbox. But there were other computers at other sites where scientists were working on the same project. Tomlinson's idea was to figure out a way to deliver messages to mailboxes on those remote computers. He used the @ sign to identify messages that were headed out of the local machine to the more distant ones. That was the start of the emailing systems that we still use today.

At first, the number of people on email was small, but by the end of the 20th century, there were 263 million email boxes. In the 21st century, that figure has grown to over 4 billion, and the functions of email services in the future will become more and more diversified. And text messaging on cell phones is also increasing, so people can, in effect, be in constant touch with people who are long distances away.

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## After Reading

Complete the following sentences about the reading.

1. People have shown a need to communicate with one another since _____.
2. When Native Americans saw two columns of smoke, _____.
3. Although drums are used in Central Africa to communicate messages, only a few non-natives _____.
4. When Tomlinson sent his first message, he wasn't thinking of _____.
5. Although email only began in the 1970s, by the end of the 20th century, _____.
6. Nowadays, billions of people are used to _____.

## Discussion

1. Think about how you communicate with different people.
2. Work in groups. Make notes in the chart below.
3. Use your notes to talk about communication in class.
4. Which are the most common and most effective ways? Why?

| | Ways I communicate | Advantages | Disadvantages |
|---|---|---|---|
| With friends | | | |
| With relatives | | | |
| With other people who live far away | | | |

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# 10 Writing

**A.** **1.** Work in pairs. Compare the emails from Mr. Saleh and Melanie on pages 106 and 107. Make notes in the chart below.
**2.** Use your notes to report in class. Discuss differences and similarities.
**3.** Why do you think there are differences?

| Email | Page 106 | Page 107 |
|---|---|---|
| From | | |
| To | | |
| Greeting | | |
| Opening lines | | |
| Topic/information content | | |
| Closing lines | | |
| Signed | | |
| Purpose of email | | |

**B.** **1.** Read the email from Adel to his friend in the USA and answer the questions.
- Where did Adel spend the summer?
- What time of year is it?
- How does Adel feel about starting school again?
- Why is he excited about the weekend?

**2.** What does *P.S.* stand for? Why do we use it?
**3.** Which email in your book is this email similar to? How do you know?

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Back to school

Reply | Reply to all | Forward | Print | Delete

To: brian@megagoal.com
Cc:
Subject: Back to school
Attachment: 200.jpg

Hi Brian,

How are you doing? Did you have a good summer? How's school? I guess you've just started again, right? Well, that's life. I am attaching a photo of us at the game. How do you like it? We look good, huh? 🙂

This is our first week back and everyone is trying to get used to getting up early, spending most of the day at school then home, homework, etc. But we have some great plans for the weekend. We'll drive to the desert with my cousins and spend the night there. I wish you could come along. It would be so much fun.

Guess what? My father promised to let me drive the jeep in the desert. Isn't that cool? What about you? Any special plans for the weekend?

Don't forget. It's your turn next summer. You are going to come to Saudi Arabia and stay with us. I'd better not talk about the summer now. Time to get organized and get down to homework!

Give my best to your family.

Adel

P.S. My teacher complimented me on my English! I told him I had spent two months practicing with my friend!

1. You want to write an email to a friend.
2. Decide who you are going to write to and what you are going to write about.
3. Complete the chart with your notes. Then use your notes to write the email.

| Email | My notes |
|---|---|
| My greetings: | |
| My opening words: | |
| My reasons for writing this email: | |
| My closing words: | |
| Attached documents: | |

## Writing Corner

When you write an email to a friend:

- **Greet and sign your letter in an informal manner, e.g.** *Hi/Hello/Dear* **+ first name and** *Best/Best wishes/See you soon/Take care* **+ your first name.**
- Write as if you were speaking to him/her, i.e. use contracted forms, emoticons, or abbreviations.

When you write to a business/professional contact:

- **Address and sign the letter more formally, e.g.** *Dear Sir/Madam/Dear Mr./Mrs.* **+ last name and** *Kind regards/Best regards/Sincerely.*
- Do not use contracted or abbreviated forms.

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# 11 Form, Meaning and Function

## Simple Past with *Used to*

Use *used to* for past states, habits and situations that are no longer true.

Morse, the inventor of the telegraph system, **used to be** a professor at New York University. He **used to teach** arts and design.

People **used to communicate** by telegraph. Telegraph companies **used to dispatch** telegraphs by train across the United States.

| Yes/No Questions (?) | Answer |
|---|---|
| **Did** you **use to have** a blue car? | Yes, I did. I sold it three years ago. |
| **Did** they **use to play** football every week? | No, they didn't. The used to play tennis. |

## *Used to* and *Would*

We can also use *would* in place of *used to* for past habits but we cannot use *would* for past states.

In ancient times, people **would shout** messages to the next tower in order to pass on information through the area. People **used to have** very powerful voices in those days!

**INCORRECT:** ~~People would have very powerful voices.~~

| Information Questions (?) | Answer |
|---|---|
| **How did** people in the Americas **use to transmit** messages? | They used smoke signals. |
| **Why did** people **use to shout** from signal towers? | They wanted to pass on messages. |
| **What did** you **use to do** when you were young? | I used to ride my bike in the park. |

**A.** Complete the paragraph with the correct form of the verbs in parentheses. Use ***used to, would*** and ***didn't use to***.

My grandparents often tell me that life before the Internet was very different to how it is nowadays. When my grandfather was young, he _____ (1. have) a computer, laptop, tablet or even a cell phone!

He told me that in those days, people _____ (2. speak) to people on a phone that was fixed to the wall of the house. People _____ (3. use) their phones to take digital images. They _____ (4. take) photos with a camera that needed a special roll of film. They _____ (5. print) the photos on a special kind of paper and put them in a photo album.

Moreover, people _____ (6. find) information in books, and they _____ (7. use) actual paper maps to get to places! They also _____ (8. read) paper newspapers which a paper boy _____ (9. deliver) to their house. My grandfather said it was just like getting a printed Internet on their doorstep every morning!

These days it is much quicker to find information and stay in touch, but life before the Internet sure sounds amazing!

**B.** Work with a partner. Talk about what your grandparents ***used to*** and ***didn't used to do***.

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## There is/There are

**Singular nouns**

**There is** a phone message for you.

**Plural nouns**

**There are** lots of unanswered emails in my inbox.

## Plurals

**Regular nouns**

For most regular nouns we add **-s** to form the plural. If the noun ends in **-s, -ch, -sh, -o,** or **-x**, we add **-es.** For regular nouns that end in **-y**, we usually drop the 'y' and add **-ies** for the plural. For regular nouns that end in **-f** or **-fe**, we change the ending to **-ves**.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| letter—letters | inbox—inboxes | city—cities | leaf—leaves |
| card—cards | business—businesses | company—companies | wife—wives |
| email—emails | watch—watches | story—stories | life—lives |

**Note:** If the noun has a vowel before the final **-y** then we add an **-s**: boy—boys; day—days; donkey—donkeys, etc.

**Irregular nouns**

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| man—men | child—children | foot—feet | deer—deer |
| woman—women | tooth—teeth | mouse—mice | fish—fish |

## Definite Article: *The*

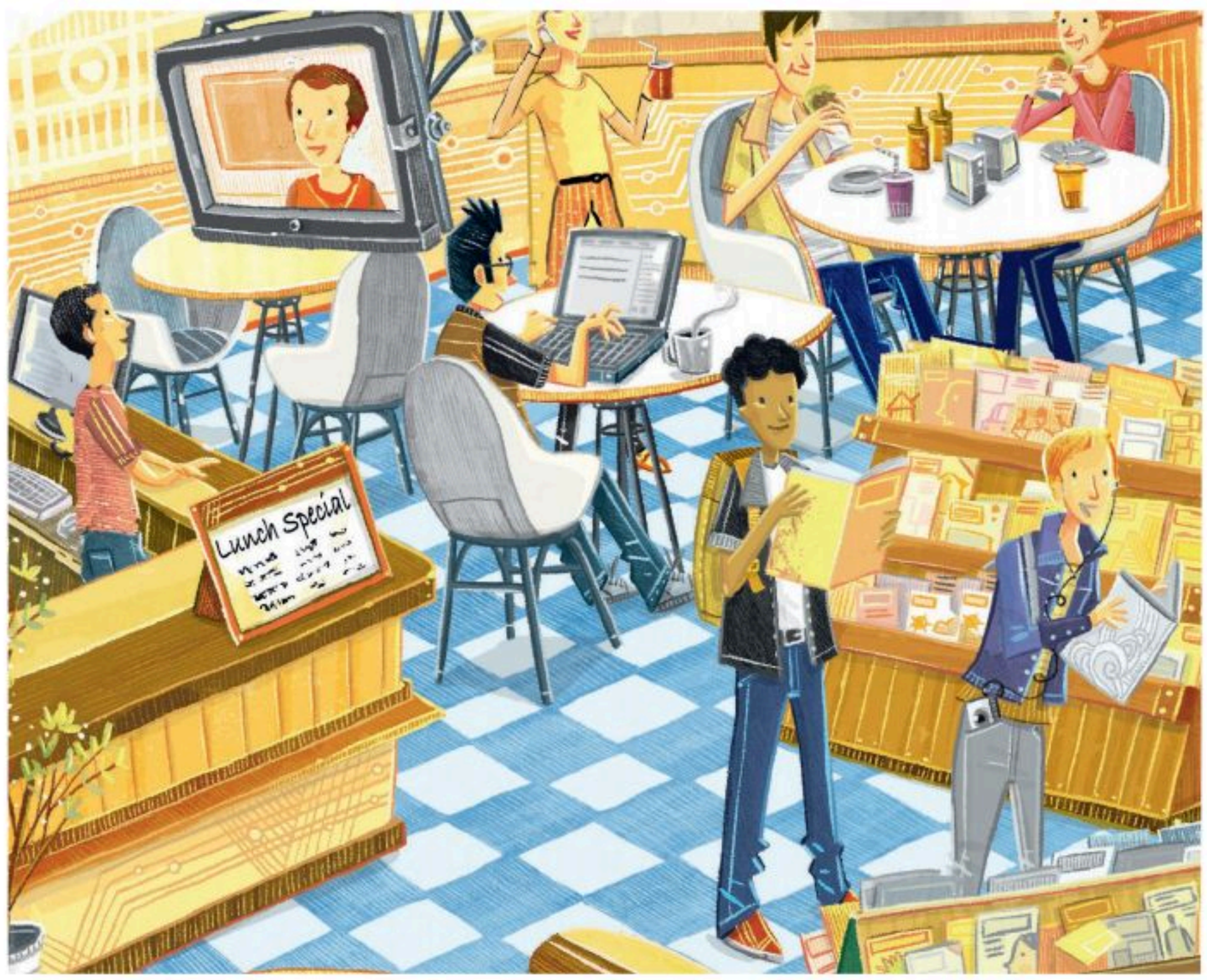
Use the definite article *the* before singular and plural nouns when we know what or who we are referring to.
**The** children at the local school got some new computers.

Use the definite article *the* for objects that are one of a kind: **the** Internet, **the** sun, **the** Masmak Fortress, **the** Holy Qur'an.

**C.** Look at the picture. Write sentences to describe the different ways people communicate. Compare with a partner.

*There is a man writing an email on a computer.*

**D.** With a partner, talk about how you stay in touch with family and friends. Is this the same or different to when you were younger? Why?

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## 12 Project

1. Design a greeting card for Saudi Arabia National Day.
2. Think about events and emotions on that day and complete the chart with your notes.

| | Occasion |
|---|---|
| My notes | Saudi Arabia National Day |
| Actions on that day (verbs) | |
| Naming words on that day (nouns) | |
| Describing words for that day (adjectives) | |
| Emotion words on that day | |

3. Write 2 to 3 sentences/messages about Saudi Arabia National Day using some of the ideas/words you listed above.
4. Design your card. Search and find suitable photos/pictures or draw your own. Make sure that your photo/drawing is related to your sentences.
5. Choose the sentence or sentences that you are going to include and write them on your card.
6. Decide who you are going to send your card to.

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# 13 Self Reflection

| Things that I liked about Unit 7: | Things that I didn't like very much: |
|---|---|
| _____ | _____ |
| _____ | _____ |

| Things that I found easy in Unit 7: | Things that I found difficult in Unit 7: |
|---|---|
| _____ | _____ |
| _____ | _____ |

| Unit 7 Checklist | I can do this very well. | I can do this quite well. | I need to study/ practice more. |
|---|---|---|---|
| discuss email and letter format and etiquette | | | |
| make and accept an apology | | | |
| wish someone success | | | |
| make arrangements, accept and refuse invitations | | | |
| use the construction preposition + gerund | | | |
| use *although, even though,* and *in spite of* | | | |
| use *as soon as* and *when;* | | | |
| use *so...(that)* | | | |
| use *used to* and *would* | | | |
| use *there is/are* + singular and plural nouns | | | |
| use the definite article: *the* | | | |

| My five favorite new words from Unit 7: | If you're still not sure about something from Unit 7: |
|---|---|
| _____ | • read through the unit again |
| _____ | • listen to the audio material |
| _____ | • study the grammar and functions from the unit again |
| | • ask your teacher for help |

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